

Sudanese

Gum

olibanum

صمغ اللبان (لبان البخور)

Boswellia papyrifera

Frankincense, graded tears



Boswellia papyrifera
Botanical source

Raw tears, graded
Form

1301.90
HS code (indicative)

1 Scope

This sheet applies to the dry exudate of *Boswellia papyrifera* exported by Asmagh Sudanese Exports from Port Sudan.

2 Synonyms

Frankincense

Luban (لبان)

Oleo-gum-resin

Amyris papyrifera

3 Definition

Gum olibanum is the oleo-gum-resin that exudes from the tapped stems and branches of *Boswellia papyrifera* (Caill. ex Delile) Hochst., family Burseraceae, and dries on the tree. It is a natural mixture of an alcohol-soluble resin, rich in triterpene (boswellic) acids; a water-soluble gum (polysaccharide); and an essential oil.

4 Description

A pale yellow to greenish-yellow solid in irregular tears and fragments, which soften into a slightly plastic mass when pressed. Characteristic pleasant odour and bitter taste. Lower grades may contain sand and pieces of bark. The trees grow on the hills of south-eastern Sudan and are tapped by hand.

5 Commercial grades

Grade	Particle size	Bark
Naqawa (Nagawa)	> 10 mm	Free
Grade 1	5 – 10 mm	Free
Grade 2	2.5 – 5 mm	Free
Grade 3 (Soksokania)	< 2.5 mm	Free
Grade 4	Mixed sizes	Some bark

Available as Raw tears, sorted by size

6 Uses



Incense



Perfumery, as a fixative



Essential oil distillation



Traditional remedies

7 Characteristics

7.1 Identification

Solubility	Partly soluble in water, forming a milky emulsion (the gum fraction); the resin fraction dissolves in alcohol
Odour and taste	Characteristic pleasant odour; bitter taste
Essential oil	The oil of <i>Boswellia papyrifera</i> is dominated by octyl acetate, which sets it apart from other frankincense species

7.2 Purity

	Essential oil content ≥ 2 % Loss on drying ≤ 10 % 105 °C, 5 h; includes some volatile oil Total ash ≤ 2 %	Heavy metals ≤ 40 mg/kg <i>Escherichia coli</i> Negative in 1 g <i>Salmonella</i> spp. Negative per test
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Percent by mass, on the dry weight basis except loss on drying.

8 Packaging

Multi-layer paper bags lined with polyethylene, 25-50 kg, or as agreed between buyer and supplier.

Container load about 18 MT per 20 ft container.

9 Storage

Stored under clean, cool and dry conditions in a properly built warehouse.



10 Labelling

Every package carries a clear label showing:

Product name  Gum olibanum	Product grade  e.g. Naqawa or Grade 1	Production and expiry date  Month and year	Code  Lot code
Country of origin  Sudan	Place of processing  Sudan	Net weight (kg)  25 or 50 kg	Producing company  Asmagh Sudanese Exports

11 Shelf life

Two years, under the storage conditions in section 9.

12 Sampling and testing

Samples are taken according to Sudanese Standard SDS 145. Tests follow Sudanese Standards SDS 146-149, 152-155, 157, 158 and 528, on the dry weight basis.

Each shipment carries an SSMO analysis and quality certificate.

From field to port

من الحقل إلى الميناء

Every lot is sampled on arrival, cleaned, graded by size and tested before it is packed. Storage and loading are checked too, because quality can be lost after processing.

1 Our quality process

1



Sourcing

Bought from collectors on the hills of south-eastern Sudan, where the trees are tapped by hand.

2



Cleaning

Bark, sand and foreign matter removed by hand.

3



Grading

Sieved and hand-sorted by size into Naqawa and Grades 1 to 4.

4



Testing

Samples tested for oil content, loss on drying and ash.

5



Packing

Packed in lined 25 or 50 kg bags marked with product, grade, lot and weight.

6



Storage

Kept clean, cool and dry until loading.

7



Loading

Containers inspected before stuffing; loading is supervised.

8



Shipping

Shipped from Port Sudan with the full set of export documents.

2 Origin and shipping

Olibanum comes from *Boswellia papyrifera* trees on the hills of south-eastern Sudan. Like gum arabic, it is tapped by hand and dries on the tree, then travels to Port Sudan on the Red Sea for export.

HS code	1301.90 (indicative; confirm with your customs broker)
Port of loading	Port Sudan (SDPZU), Red Sea
Container load	About 18 MT per 20 ft container
Ready to load	Usually 10–15 days after contract
Transit	About 2–8 weeks, by destination
Delivery terms	FOB Port Sudan, CFR or CIF
Payment terms	Irrevocable L/C at sight, TT advance, or D/P
Samples	Free; courier paid by the buyer



3 Export documents

Certificates travel with each shipment and are exchanged through the banks or directly with the buyer, so the goods clear customs at destination.

Product certificates



Certificate of origin
Sudan Chamber of Commerce; general or preferential forms.



Phytosanitary certificate
Official inspection against the importing country's pest list.



Analysis and quality certificate
Issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).



Fumigation certificate
Treatment, chemical, dose and temperature used.



Inspection certificate
Optional; by an international inspection company chosen by the buyer.

Shipping documents



Export contract
Attested by the Ministry of Trade and the Chamber of Commerce.



Commercial invoice
Goods, quantity, value and terms.



Packing list
Every bag in each container, with counts and weights.



Bill of lading
Issued by the shipping line on loading.

4 Standards and references

- Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO): SDS 145 (sampling); SDS 146–149, 152–155, 157, 158 and 528 (test methods).
- Abd El Wahab, S. M. et al. (1987). The essential oils of olibanum. *Planta Medica*, 53, 382–384.
- Abd El-Kariem, E. H. (1992). Structural studies of some Sudanese gums. PhD thesis, University of Khartoum.
- Mustafa, G. I. (1997). Physico-chemical study on oleo-gums from Sudan. MSc thesis, University of Khartoum.
- Sahni, K. C. (1968). Important trees of the northern Sudan. Forestry Research and Education Centre, Khartoum, FAO/UNDP.

